WIDER, WISER, LIGHTER



Eight generations later, the smaller yet smarter Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 8 seems (almost) like a whole package.

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For seven generations, Samsung's foldable was a straightforward device that opened into a notebook. Jump to 2026, the Fold 8 has lost a few inches and is now shaped like a passport, which is fitting for a phone. We saw it first-hand unveiled in London on July 22, 2026 and right off the bat we fell for it. Yes, there is its bigger brother the Fold 8 Ultra in the market as well, but the talk of town is the Z Fold 8. We spent a good amount of time with this new-age device, and this is what we think of the new form factor and its shiny new brain.

Built Like a Passport, Not a Paperback

At 201 grammes and 4.5mm unfolded, this is the lightest book-style foldable Samsung has shipped. Folded, it is 9.7mm thick and unusually easy to slip into your denim pockets, which is a sentence nobody wrote about a Fold in 2019. The Advanced Armor Aluminium frame feels dense rather than hollow, the hinge closes with a satisfying finality and the cover glass is Gorilla Glass Ceramic. The IP48 rating still means dust resistance rather than dust proofing, so beaches remain a gamble.

The Crease Case is Almost Closed

Samsung's new Flex Titanium layer adds a titanium plate under the panel and the payoff is visible. The 7.6-inch inner display runs at 2,448 x 1,848 pixels with a 4:3 shape, an adaptive 1 to 120Hz refresh rate and a claimed 3,000 nits peak brightness. The crease has not vanished, but it has stopped auditioning for attention. The genuinely clever bit is the 5.5-inch cover screen, wide enough that apps stop letterboxing and typing with two thumbs stops feeling like a party trick.

Two Excellent Lenses and One Missing Friend

The rear setup is a 50MP main sensor with optical stabilisation and a 50MP ultrawide with a 120-degree field of view. Daylight shots are sharp with restrained colour and the ultrawide finally holds detail in the corners. Night mode has grown up. There are two 10MP selfie cameras, one on the cover and one under the inner display, plus 8K video and dual recording for creators. So, who is the missing friend? That is the Telephoto lens. There are just two lenses at the back (instead of usual three) and yes, we do miss it.